

## Appendix B When Not to Use AI

Maturity in the era of synthetic intelligence is defined not by how ubiquitously you deploy generative tools, but by your wisdom and moral courage in recognizing where they must never be applied.

- 1. Acute Interpersonal Vulnerability and Apology:** When you must apologize for a mistake, comfort a grieving friend, or express authentic love, delegating the message to an algorithm is an act of emotional cowardice. The moral worth of an apology or a condolence resides entirely in the vulnerable human labor required to express it.
- 2. High-Stakes Moral and Ethical Adjudication:** Decisions regarding criminal justice, child custody, military engagement, or asylum applications require moral conscience, empathy, and the capacity for mercy. An algorithm can calculate statistical probabilities; it cannot bear moral accountability.
- 3. High-Stakes Clinical Diagnostics Without Direct Oversight:** While machine learning can assist clinicians in spotting patterns, it must never serve as the autonomous arbiter in diagnosing terminal conditions or prescribing invasive treatments without direct human physician oversight.
- 4. Foundational Learning and Competence Building:** When you are an apprentice attempting to master a core discipline (calculus, systems architecture, memory management, or essay writing), reaching for instant AI solutions short-circuits the necessary friction of productive failure, leaving you structurally incompetent.
- 5. Proprietary and Confidential Data Transmission:** Never paste unredacted Personally Identifiable Information (PII), proprietary source code, cryptographic secrets, or confidential client records into cloud-hosted commercial prompt interfaces.
- 6. When the Effort Is the Point:** Not every human endeavor needs to be optimized for maximum efficiency. Protect personal memoirs, physical craft, slow reading, and creative exploration as areas where unassisted human effort is the real source of meaning.